



Language work: future forms

1. Choose the correct words in brackets to complete these sentences.

- a) In the future, I hope we (*will have / are going to have*) robots in the home to help us with the housework.
- b) Hey, Nick, be careful. You (*will spill / are going to spill*) that coffee on the computer!
- c) It's John's birthday next week. We (*will give / are going to give*) him a mobile phone.
- d) – My laptop has crashed! / - Don't worry. I (*will lend / am going to lend*) you mine.
- e) The Internet (*will probably change / is probably going to change*) the publishing industry in the way that TV changed the movie industry.
- f) Futurists predict that smart technology (*will be / is going to be*) incorporated into fabrics, so you'll be able to email from your coat!

We use the future simple (*will / won't + infinitive*) in the following ways:

- **To make predictions when you don't have present evidence that something will happen** (Nanobots will be injected into the body's bloodstream to treat diseases.)
- **To talk about hopes and promises, especially with the words expect, think, hope and probably** (They hope that people will interact naturally with hundreds of smart devices at a time.)
- **To describe an instant decision, often when we make an offer** (Sure, I'll help you with your homework.)
- **To talk about facts that will inevitably happen** (She'll be 21 in May.)

We use *be going to + infinitive* in the following ways:

- **To describe future intentions** (She's going to write a book about ubiquitous computing.)
- **To make predictions when you have present evidence that something is going to happen** (By all accounts, nanotechnology is going to have a huge impact on business and our daily lives.)

We use the future continuous (*will be + -ing form of the verb*) **to talk about actions in progress at a specific time in the future** (In a few years, doctors will be using expert systems to diagnose illnesses.)

We use the future perfect (*will have + past participle*) **to talk about actions finished at a specific time in the future** (Soon, engineers will have built different types of android.)



2. Complete these sentences with the correct future form of the verb in brackets. Use the future continuous or future perfect.

- a) Thanks to IT, by the year 2030 we _____ (find) cures for the major diseases of our time.
- b) In twenty years' time, some people _____ (live) in space, perhaps inside a computerized colony.
- c) By this time next week, I _____ (work) for IBM.
- d) By this time next month, I _____ (buy) that BlackBerry that I've been waiting to buy for months.
- e) Scientists predict that in twenty years' time nearly everyone _____ (live) in smart houses.